Acknowledgements

Authors, contributors, data providers and funders

IUCN Red List of Ecosystems · Last updated 28 October 2026 · www.iucnrle.org

The first Global Red List of Coral Reef Ecosystems was made possible by the work of hundreds of people and institutions: regional expert teams, monitoring programmes, data custodians, local communities and funders. We are deeply grateful to all of them.

Coordination

IUCN; University of Melbourne; CORDIO East Africa.

Funders

Main funder: MSC Foundation.

Regional contributions: DELTA Environmental and Educational Foundation; Global Affairs Canada.

Funding and in-kind support for regional assessments and data collection: DAAD and BMFTR (ETP); Tamkeen and Mubadala (ROPME); NYU Abu Dhabi Institute (ROPME); Australian Research Council and OceanWise Australia (Australia); CNPq, CAPES, FACEPE, FUNBIO, Instituto Serrapilheira and the Petrobras Socio-environmental Program (Brazil). Many other regional partners also provided in-kind support that made the ten regional assessments possible.

Authors of the regional assessments

Australia: Ben Fitzpatrick, Vania Andreoli, Kristina Heidrich, Mishal Gudka, Franz Smith, Yves-Marie Bozec, Benjamin Cresswell, Nicholas J. Murray

Brazil: Beatrice Padovani Ferreira, Camila Brasil L. da Silveira, Jéssica Borba Q. dos Santos, Thales Jean Vidal, Ana Lídia Bertoldi Gaspar, Luísa V. M. de Vasconcelos Queiroz-Véras, Ágatha Naiara Ninow, Fernando Castro Cardoso, Guilherme O. Longo, Kelly Yumi Inagaki, Giovanna Destri, Tito Lotufo, César A. M. M. Cordeiro, Rodrigo Leão de Moura, Carlos Hackradt, Fabiana Hackradt, Carlos Eduardo L. Ferreira, Miguel Mies, Mariana Coxey, Thiago B. N. de Oliveira, Mauro Maida, Zelinda Leão, Ruy K. P. Kikuchi, João Lucas Leão Feitosa, Jorge Luiz Silva Nunes, Cláudio Sampaio, Bráulio Almeida Santos, Leonardo T. Messias, Ana Paula Leite Prates, Franz Smith, Mishal Gudka

Caribbean: Jack V. Johnson, Franz Smith, Melanie McField, Jahson Alemu I, Lorenzo Alvarez-Filip, Ruleo Camacho, Luis Chasqui, James Crabbe, Aldo Croquer, Craig Dahlgren, Haley Davis, Matthew L. Doherty, Brett Jameson, Patricia Kramer, Judith Lang, Rosa E. Rodríguez-Martínez, Angela Randazzo, Lynnette Roth, Krista Sherman, Anastazia Teresa Banaszak, Maria F. Villalpando, Mishal Gudka

East Asia: Georg Valentin Flückiger, Danwei Huang, Ray Jing Tong, James Philip de Vera Cabatbat, Rickdane Gomez, Lucas Yutaka Kimura, Chin Soon Lionel Ng, Tadashi Kimura, Karenne Tun, Loke Ming Chou, Hui Huang, Jiansheng Lian, Lintao Huang, Lei Jiang, Apple Pui Yi Chui, Put Ang Jr., Chaolun Allen Chen, Ya-Yi Huang, Chao-Yang Kuo, Takashi Nakamura, Yuko Kitano, Taihun Kim, Heung-sik Park, Frederick Chong, Leonora Yeo, Ouk Vibol, Rikoh Manogar Siringoringo, Giyanto, Muhammad Abrar, Rizkie Satriya Utama, Yang Amri Affendi, Zarinah Waheed,

Hin Boo Wee, Zau Lunn, Cleto Lema Nañola Jr., Maria Vanessa Baria-Rodriguez, Rhea Mae Luciano, Tai Chong Toh, Thamasak Yeemin, Makamas Sutthacheep, Van Long Nguyen, Minh Quang Thai, Si Tuan Vo, Franz Smith, Mishal Gudka

Eastern Tropical Pacific: Andrea Arriaga-Madrigal, Manuel Olán-González, Juan P. Quimbayo, Juan José Alvarado, Imelda Amador, Arturo Ayala-Bocos, Luis Calderón-Aguilera, José Julio Casas-Maldonado, Amílcar Leví Cupul-Magaña, Priscilla Martinez, Ollin T. González-Cuellar, Rebeca Granja-Fernández, Inti Keith, Andrés López-Pérez, Nicolas Moity, Damien Olivier, Georgina Ramírez-Ortiz, Héctor Reyes-Bonilla, Fernando Rivera, Jenny Carolina Rodríguez-Villalobos, Fabián A. Rodríguez-Zaragoza, Johanna Segovia-Prado, Omar Valencia-Méndez, Franz Smith, Mishal Gudka, Sonia Bejarano, Fernando A. Zapata

Pacific: Mathilde Maslin, Vania Andreoli, Kristina Heidrich, Ben Fitzpatrick, Jack Johnson, Johanna Johnson, Sangeeta Mangubhai, Mohsen Kayal, Mehdi Adjeroud, Helen Sykes, Karen Stone, Lucy Southworth, Sheila McKenna, Tom Heintz, Sandrine Job, Laurent Wantiez, Mishal Gudka, Franz Smith

Red Sea & Gulf of Aden: Maher A. Amer, Swaleh Aboud, Tamer Attalla, Matthew D. Tietbohl Talas, Ahmad Ghallab, Sheikheldin M. Elamin, Amjed Ginawy, Gaafar Baomer, Mohamed A. Hassan, Saleem Nawaiseh, Franz Smith, Mishal Gudka, Mohamed H. Farah

ROPME Sea Area: Rita C. Bento, Amal Al Gergawi, Jenan Al Asfoor, Suaad Al Harthi, Reem AlMealla, Rawan Alkhudhair, Ivonne Bejarano, Sudhanshu Dixit, Amir Ghazilou, Antoine O.H.C. Leduc, Elayne Looker, Nithyanandan Manickam, Daniel Mateos-Molina, Pedro Range, Mohammad R. Shokri, Goutham Sambath, Oli Taylor, Mishal Gudka, Franz Smith, John A. Burt

South Asia: Min Hein Htike, Swaleh Aboud, Mishal Gudka, Ahmed Najeeb, C. Raghunathan, Franz Smith, Chandran Rethinaraj, J.S. Yogesh Kumar, K. Diraviya Raj, Mariyam Shidha Afzal, Mohammed Shah Nawaz Chowdhury, Naalin Perera, Rohan Arthur, Ronan Roche, Tamal Mondal

Western Indian Ocean: Mishal Gudka, Abigail Mwalimu, Karin Moejes, Nimrod Ishmael, Diana Karan, Melita Samoilys, David Obura, Said Ahamada, Léo Barret, Lionel Bigot, Bruce Cauvin, Gilberte Gendron, Pagu Julius, Juliet Karisa, Ewout Knoester, Alex H. O'Brien, Sean Porter, Ronan Roche, Franz Smith, Gildas Todinanahary, Julien Wickel, Francisco Zivane

Contributors

Mariam Amr, Juliana Vasconcelos Baptista, Ahmed Basheer, Anne Karolline Costa, Kerryn Crossman, Muhammad Dosoky, Eman Elshorbagy, Mike Emslie, Abdelsalam Erdan, Richard Evans, Shady Fathy, Renata Ferrari, Somaya Ghoraba, Jordan Goertze, Manuel Gonzalez-Rivero, Jean-Paul Hobbs, Andrew Hoey, Mai Hussain, Moustapha Ibrahim, Hamad A. Al Jailani, Fatemah Jamal, Chaminda Karunarathne, Emma Kennedy, Christopher Lawson, Anna Carolina Lins, Jennie Mallela, James Mbugua, Osama Melika, Yacout Mohamed, Ahmed Mokhtar, Asmahan Moustafa, Mohammed Muthaffar, Lizzi Oh, Yves Olatoundji, Asrar Qubouri, Arjan Rajasuriya, Moshera Ramadan, Claire Ross, Jodi Salmond, Beatriz Fernandes de B B Santana, Nada Seif, Sahar Shar, Abu Sayeed Muhammad Sharif, Iara Braga Sommer, Ena Suárez, Sterling Tebbett, Angus Thompson, Ahmed Thwban, Maria Carolina Chalegre Touceira, Marcos Valderrábano, Eyad Zghool

Data providers and monitoring programmes

Australia: Australian Institute of Marine Science (AIMS); Department of Biodiversity, Conservation and Attractions, Western Australia (DBCA), primary custodian and funding contributor of the monitoring data for West Pilbara and Dampier Archipelago as well as Western Australian marine parks (Ningaloo, Shark Bay, Montebello Islands, Rowley Shoals, and North Kimberley (Balanggarra and Wunambal Gaambera Aboriginal Corporations)); Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation (CSIRO); Reef Life Survey; Institute for Marine and Antarctic Studies, University of Tasmania; Reef Check Foundation; James Cook University; Coral Sea Marine Park and Parks Australia; Citizens of the Reef; Seaview Survey; The Australian National University; Reef Science Consulting; Australian Research Council; OceanWise Australia.

Brazil: Ministry of the Environment and Climate Change (MMA); Chico Mendes Institute for Biodiversity Conservation (ICMBio); CEPENE; Federal Universities of Pernambuco (UFPE), Bahia (UFBA), Rio Grande do Norte (UFRN), Paraíba (UFPB), Alagoas (UFAL) and Rio de Janeiro (UFRJ); University of São Paulo (USP); WWF-Brazil; Instituto Recifes Costeiros; monitoring programmes PELD TAMS, PELD ILOC, PELD ABRS, Reef Check Brasil, De Olho nos Corais, IntegraMar, Projeto Coral Vivo and Projeto Budiões. Supporting research and monitoring: CNPq, CAPES, FACEPE, FUNBIO, Instituto Serrapilheira, Petrobras Socio-environmental Program, GEF Mar, PROMAR, Grupo Cataratas, Atlantis Divers, All Angle and FADE/UFPE.

Caribbean: Global Coral Reef Monitoring Network (GCRMN) Caribbean node. Individuals and their organisations that contributed data: Peter J. Edmunds, Jan Freiwald, Jenny Mihaly, Paula Sills, Felipe Ossandon, Leslie Hickerson, Laëtitia Mathon, Anna Venema, Tadzio Bervoets, Ainhoa Leon Zubillaga, Rebecca Garcia Camps, Andreina Rivera, Geury Guerrero, Lizeth Cruz, Emy Miyazawa, Maria G. Aponte, Shamwari Anseeuw, Tyler B. Smith, Lauren Olinger, Nicole Krampitz, Sarah Heidmann, Maria F. Villalpando, Rita I. Sellares-Blasco, Aldo Croquer, Sergio D. Guendulain-García, Andreina Valdez-Trinidad, Julien Chalifour, Amandine Bordin, Aude Berger, Clément Bonnardel, Vincent Oliva, Mark Vermeij, Sandin Stuart, Thaddeus Murdoch, Struan Robertson Smith, Leo Brewster, Shoneé Howell, Miguel Figuerola Hernández, Maria Vega Rodriguez, Eric Appeldoorn Sanders, Sven Zea, Catalina Gómez-Cubillos, Carlos Daza-Guerra, Juan José Alvarado Barrientos, Fabio Quesada-Perez, Cindy Fernández-García, Claude Bouchon, Yolande Bouchon-Navaro, Sarah Leinbach, David Gilliam, Michael Colella, Rob Ruzicka, Stephanie Stinson, Robert Steneck, Erik H. Meesters, Rolf P.M. Bak, Didier M. de Bakker, Matthijs van der Geest, Thomas Kemenes van Uden, Gerard Nieuwland, Maggy Nugues, Andreas Haas, Caren Eckrich, Erica K. Towle, Ethan Degner, Clare Morrall, Robert Anderson, Robert Balza, James Henkel, Courtney Moll, Stephen Nimrod, Valeria Pizarro, Pilar Herrón, Juliana Vanegas Gonzalez, Katalina Henao Orozco, Monique Curtis, Tamarah Myles, Chanel Raynor, Lorenzo Alvarez-Filip, Esmeralda Perez-Cervantes, Fernando J. Pardo Urrutia, Heidi Hertler, John DeBuysser, Patricia González Díaz, Juliett González Méndez, Gabriela Aguilera Pérez, Amanda Ramos Romero, Patricia Vicente Castro, Melissa Arbona Fernández, Joan Hernández Albernas, Dorka Cobian Rojas, Raul Igor Corrada Wong, Jahson Alemu I, Alwin Hylkema, Marnik Lehwald, Callum Roberts, Julie Hawkins, Chantale Bégin, John Parkinson, Sydney Tritschler, Sandra Little, Jean-Philippe Maréchal, Ewan Trégarot, Priscilla Dupont, Hélène Legrand, Yann Rousseau, Cécile Pérez, Max Louis, Sophie Brugneaux, Bernard Renaudie, Laurent Juhel, Claude Séraline, Josianne Mahieu, Gilles Delouche, Jennie Mallela, Graham Forrester, Johanna Calle-Triviño, Macarena Blanco, Ernesto Arias, Victor Galván, Melanie McField, Alexander R. McLeod, Rebecca Hamel Pepin, Alex O'Brien, Tom Martin, Rodrigo Garza, Antar Perez, and Mariana Reyna. Atlantic and Gulf Rapid Reef Assessment (AGRRA) Program Data Platform and AGRRA surveyors: Achsah Mitchell, Alannah Vellacott, Alba Gonzalez-Posada, Ale Thompson, Alejandra Thompson, Alejandro Cordova Morales, Alejandro Flores, Alerick Pacay, Alexis Medina, Alido Luis Baez, Alwyn Gatt, Ana Betancourth, Ana Giro, Ana Hacohen Domene, Ana Lilia Molina Hernandez, Ana Rivera, Andrea Cerrato, Andrea Godoy Mendoza, Andrea Izaguirre, Andrea Rivera-Sosa, Andres Romero Lopez, Andrew Ross, Ángela Mojica, Angela Rendazzo, Angelica Vazquez Machorro, Antal Borckzoc, Antal Borcsok, Anthony Collins, Antonella Rivera, Arlene Rodriguez, Arturo Corvino, Aurora Claudia Padilla Souza, Baruch Figueroa Zavala, Beatriz Arellano, Bianca Capua, Blanca Quiroga, Caitlin Chock, Candice Brittain, Carlos Mechel, Carlos Mechell, Carolina Garza, Christian Alva, Clare Morrall, Claudia Guerrero, Clement Alvarez, Cornelia Baker, Cristhian Eduardo Perez, Cristina Cortes Gomez, Cristopher Avalos, Damaris Dueñas, Daniel Aurelio, Daniel Hughes, Daniela Mejía, Dave Grenda, David Diaz, David Gonzalez, David Penados, Denzel Adams, Diana Martinez, Diego Ardon, Don Stark, Dulce Mariana Tapia Aguirre, Edgar Guzman, Edoardo Antunez, Eduardo Antonio Avila Pech, Elvira Italia Moreno Rodriguez, Erika Gress, Ernesto Hevia, Ernesto Hevia del Puerto, Esmeralda Perez, Esmeralda Perez Cervantes, Fiama Molina, Florencia Cerutti, Francin Murcia, Francin Varela, Francisco Polanco, Franziska Elmer, Gabriel Garcia Ayala, Gabriela Ochoa, Gisselle Brady, Guillermo Galvez, Hazel Araujo, Heydi Paola Gomez, Horacio Pérez-España, Ian Drysdale, Isis Martinez, Israel Cruz Ortega, Israel Muniz-Castillo, Italia Moreno, Itzel Zamora Vilchis, Jaedon Lawe, Jasiel Murphy, Javier Gonzalez, Jennifer Myton, Jeremy Searles, Jerrad Drellishak, Jerry Enoe, Jhoan Gutierrez, Jim Clark, Jimmy Arguelles Jimenez, John Bodden, Jorge Brenner, Jorge Mendoza, Jose Flores, Jose Olivares, Joyce Schulke, Juan Carlos Carrasco, Judith Lang, Karen Macias, Karl Trow, Katlynd Treiber-Vajda, Kayla Moore, Kelvin Baldayac, Ken Marks, Kendon James, Kimani Kitson-Walters, Kimberley Coore, Laura Palmese, Laurine Dherbomez, Lindy C. Knowles, Lorenzo Alvarez-Filip, Luis Flores, Manuel Olan, Manuel Victoria Muguira, Maria Fernanda Gastelu, Maria Fernanda Pavon Rodriguez,

Maria Geovana Leon Pech, Maria Jose Hernandez Duenas, Maria Villalpando, Mariana Rivera Higueras, Mariela Ochoa, Marielle Harper, Marieta Marroquin, Marisol Rueda Flores, Mark "Steve" Archibald, Mat Slattery, Mateo Sabido, Max Bodmer, Mayra Núñez, Mayra Vallecillo, Melanie McField, Melina Soto, Melissa Mayorga Martinez, Merary Contreras Juarez, Michelle McNaught, Molly Wilson, Monique Curtis, Myles Phillips, Nadia Sandoval, Nicole Craig, Nicte Ha Munoz, Nikyta Van den Abbeel, Noemi Espinosa, Nuria Estrada, Olando Harvey, Olivia Moudy, Paco Lacoste, Pamela Ortega, Paolo Guardiola, Philip Kramer, Rachel D'Silva, Rafael Cabral Tena, Raj Heinz Mathias, Raphael Martinez, Raul Tecalco Renteria, Reynhold Gelera, Rich Wilson, Richard Archer, Rita Sellares, Roberto Ibarra Navarro, Rodrigo Alfredo Nunez-Inzunza, Rodrigo Diaz Talamantes, Rodrigo Nunez, Roxanna Rodriguez, Roz-Anna Baker, Ruben Torres, Ruleo Camacho, Samuel King, Sandra Mendoza, Sandy Voegeli, Sara Gutierrez Plata, Sara Madrid, Sara Melo, Sherron Barker, Simone Lee, Sobeida Nunez, Sophia Punnett, Sophia Steele, Sophia Vasiliou, Stacey Williams, Stephen Nimrod, Steve Nimrod, Suzanne Palmer, Tamara Adame, Tanya Barona, Tatiana Medel Alvarado, Teresa Martin, Thomas Sweeney, Trevor Joseph, Valeria Valladares, Veronica Caviedes, Victoria Grosso, William Heyman, Ximena Arvizu, and Zara Lizzeth Zuniga Lopez.

East Asia: GCRMN East Asia node; MERMAID data platform; Reef Life Survey (Integrated Marine Observing System, IMOS); Yayasan Konservasi Alam Nusantara (YKAN); Indonesian Ministry of Marine Affairs and Fisheries (MMAF).

Eastern Tropical Pacific: Universidad del Valle; Leibniz Centre for Tropical Marine Research (ZMT); Universidad de Costa Rica; Ecodesarrollo Papagayo; Universidad de El Salvador; Ministerio de Medio Ambiente y Recursos Naturales de El Salvador; Universidad de Guadalajara; SECIHTI; WildCoast; Galápagos National Park; Charles Darwin Foundation; Conservation International Ecuador; GIZ Ecuador; Instituto Nazca de Investigaciones Marinas; Ministerio de Ambiente y Energía del Ecuador; INVEMAR; National Natural Parks of Colombia; WWF Colombia; Fundación ECOMARES; LECAN. Funding for data collection: DAAD; BMFTR (COLDEMAR partnership); Rohr Foundation; Ocean Finance Company; Paul M. Angell Family Foundation; Lindblad Expeditions–National Geographic; Ken Collins and Jennifer Mallinson; COLCIENCIAS; UNEP-CAR/RCU; FONAM; Conservation International. With thanks to Peter Glynn, Joshua Feingold, Margarita Brandt and Fernando Pardo.

Pacific: Biosphere Foundation; C2O Pacific; CCMI; Coral Sea Foundation; CRIOBE; Service Territorial de l'Environnement de Wallis-et-Futuna; Gouvernement de la Nouvelle-Calédonie; IRD; James Cook University; MAREPOLIS; Marine Ecology Consulting; Micronesia Coral Reef Monitoring; National Geographic Society; US National Park Service; NOAA; OceanWise; Province des Îles Loyauté, Province Nord and Province Sud de la Nouvelle-Calédonie; Reef Check; RORC; Sea Women of Melanesia; SLN; GINGER-SOPRONER; Talanoa Consulting; UBC; UCSD; UNC; Vava'u Environmental Protection Association; Waitt Institute. With thanks to Eric Brown, Alan Friedlander and Lindsey Kramer (US National Park Service) for their help with aspects of the Hawaiian region assessment.

Red Sea & Gulf of Aden: PERSGA; EMARSGA; General Organization for Conservation of Coral Reefs and Turtles in the Red Sea (SHAMS), Saudi Arabia; Egyptian Environmental Affairs Agency (EEAA); King Abdullah University of Science and Technology (KAUST); HEPCA (Egypt); Red Sea University (Sudan); Hadramout University (Yemen); Aqaba Marine Reserve (Jordan); Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (Somalia); Ministry of the Environment and Sustainable Development (Djibouti); CORDIO East Africa.

ROPME Sea Area: Mubadala Arabian Center for Climate and Environmental Sciences (Mubadala ACCESS); NYU Abu Dhabi Institute; Tamkeen; Mubadala; and contributors, experts and institutions across the ROPME Sea Area.

South Asia: IUCN Sri Lanka; IUCN India; Zoological Survey of India; Suganthi Devadason Marine Research Institute (SDMRI); IUCN Maldives; Maldives Marine Research Institute; Ministry of Climate Change, Environment and Energy, Maldives; Ocean University of Sri Lanka; Institute of Marine Sciences, University of Chittagong; Global Fund for Coral Reefs; Bangor University; Thriving Oceans, Nature Conservation Foundation; Social Ecological Research Frontiers; The Nature Conservancy; CORDIO East Africa; GCRMN.

Western Indian Ocean: A Rocha Kenya; AIMS; ANAC; AMA; Bee Ecological; Blue Alliance; Blue Ventures–Madagascar; Centro Terra Viva; CNRO; Chumbe Island Coral Park; CORDIO East Africa; Conservation Education Society; Ezemvelo KZN Wildlife; Federal Republic of Somalia; Flora and Fauna; GIP Réserve Naturelle Marine de La Réunion; IH.SM; Island Conservation Society; iSimangaliso Wetland Park Authority; KMFRI; Kenya Wildlife Service; KORAI; Lancaster University; Lamu Marine Conservation Trust; Likhulu; Marine Conservation Society Seychelles; Nosy Tanihely National Park; Northern Rangelands Trust; Oceanographic Research Institute; Office

Français de la Biodiversité; Operation Wallacea; Parc Naturel Marin de Mayotte; Projet Récif Île Sainte-Marie; Reef Check; REEFolution; Save Our Seas Foundation–D'Arros Research Centre; Seychelles Islands Foundation; Seychelles Parks and Gardens Authority; Terres australes et antarctiques françaises; The Nature Conservancy; UniLúrio; University of the Comoros; WCS–MERMAID (WCS Kenya, Mozambique, Madagascar and Tanzania); WWF-Kenya; WWF-Madagascar; Young Researchers Organization of Madagascar; Eylem Elma; Isabel Marques da Silva; Linda Eggertsen; Quod & Bigot; and published data sources.

Contributing organisations (all regions): Biosphere Foundation, C2O Pacific, CCMI, Coral Sea Foundation, CORTEX, CRIOBE, GINGER-SOPRONER, Gouvernement de la Nouvelle-Calédonie, IRD, James Cook University, MAREPOLIS, Marine Ecology Consulting, Micronesia Coral Reef Monitoring, National Geographic Society, NOAA, OceanWise, Province Iles de la Nouvelle-Calédonie, Reef Check, RORC, Sea Women of Melanesia, Service Territorial de l'Environnement de Wallis-et-Futuna, SLN, Talanoa Consulting, UBC, UCSD, UNC, US National Park Service, Vava'u Environment, Waitt Institute.

Global datasets

NOAA Coral Reef Watch (satellite Degree Heating Weeks); Mellin et al. (2024) (projected Degree Heating Weeks); UNEP-WCMC, WorldFish Centre, WRI, TNC (2021) Global distribution of coral reefs, v4.1; Allen Coral Atlas (© 2018–2023 Allen Coral Atlas Partnership and Arizona State University, CC BY 4.0); Marine Ecoregions of the World (Spalding et al. 2007).

Traditional Owners and local communities

We thank all Traditional Owner groups of the sea countries where the studies and monitoring underpinning this assessment were conducted, and the local communities, fishers, divers and volunteers whose knowledge and efforts made it possible.